4/1/2024

Okay, this is a post processor for Vectric (seems to work on VCarve Desktop and Aspire) which has much of the functionality that Fae's does for Fusion. It handles manual tool changes for tool numbers greater than 6, manual tool changes when the max diameter of a tool is greater than 1/4", and collet changes when there is a change is tool shaft diameter between toolpaths (collets presumed are 3mm, 3.175mm(1/8"), 4mm, 6mm, and 6.35mm(1/4")).

There is a differences however. Vectric doesn't actually have a tool parameter that corresponds to collet size (or shank diameter) so I pass the collet size in the tool name in the form: Collet x (where x can be .25, .125, 6.35, 3.175, 3, or 4). I do this by passing the shank diameter using Custom Variables and format the tool name accordingly. However, you could just edit the tool name directly.

If you plan to never mix tool shank sizes in a job, then you can set the flag colletChange to false (see the current post processor). If you set colletChange to 'false' then the post processor does not check for shank size and does generate a functionally correct gcode file presuming all the bits you are using have the same shank size. WARNING!!! If you do not pass shank size (or do so incorrectly) and colletChange is set to 'true' then the post processor will issue a warning and generate a functionally incomplete gcode file. I am not sure what would happen if you executed this gcode file with the Carvera, but I suspect it could be very unpleasant.

In any case, if I were you, I would run this post processor against some Vectric job and take a close look at the generated gcode file to see if it is doing what you want. Of course, let me know if you have complaints or wish additional features.

PS. The nc codes Fae Corrigan has provided are listed in the generated gcode file so you can, if you wish, manually edit that file using those codes. There is another, less flexible, way to insert such codes. That is, you can pass them through the post processor variable TOOL_PATH NOTES (whose contents is accessible from within the Vectric app). See discussion on the Vectric forum for details.

4/19/2024

Bug Fix: Transitioning from a Manual Tool Change was broken. Should now be fixed.

4/20/24

Automated the case when a manual tool change is within the final tool path in a job.